

RG08

Livestock, Dairy and Fisheries of Rajasthan

Rajasthan Geography carries 11-15 questions a paper and animal husbandry supplies 1-2 of them, with more coming through the Economy and Science sections (research institutes, schemes). Breed matching is the single most likely format. Census ranks and the research centres at Bikaner, Jodhpur and Avikanagar are the repeat facts.

Rajasthan keeps more animals than almost any state in India, and RPSC turns that into the cleanest matching questions in the paper - breed to home district, breed to speciality, institution to city. There is nothing to understand here that a careful hour cannot fix; the whole chapter is recall, and the recall is worth 1-2 marks every single paper.

Livestock of Rajasthan

20th Census 2019

- 568 lakh animals - 2nd in India
- About 10.6% of national herd
- Goat 36.7% > cattle 24.5% > buffalo 24.1% > sheep 13.9%
- 1st in goat, camel, donkey
- Density about 166 per sq km

Cattle

- Rathi - Kamdhenu of Rajasthan
- Tharparkar - dual purpose, Thari
- Nagauri - draught
- Kankrej - sawai chaal
- Gir, Mewati, Malvi, Haryana

Sheep and wool

- Chokla - Jewel of Rajasthan
- Magra, Marwari, Nali, Pugal
- Jaisalmeri, Malpura, Sonadi
- 48% of India's wool (47.85%)
- Bikaner - Asia's largest wool market

Goat and camel

- Sirohi - meat; Jakhrana - milk
- Marwari, Barbari, Jamunapari
- Camel state animal 30 June 2014
- Bikaneri draught, Nachna riding
- Mewari - best camel milker

Dairy and institutions

- RCDF 1977, Jaipur, brand SARAS
- Three-tier Anand pattern
- RAJUVAS Bikaner 2010
- NRC on Camel, Jorbeed Bikaner
- CSWRI Avikanagar, Tonk

How big the herd is - and where Rajasthan stands

Start with what the state actually is. Rajasthan is dry, its cropping is risky, and for a large part of the population the animal is the insurance policy. When the monsoon fails the crop dies but the goat and the sheep survive, because they eat what the desert gives. That is why livestock here is not a side business - it is a second agriculture. The exam does not ask you to appreciate this. It asks you for numbers and ranks, so fix the numbers first.

- All livestock figures in the exam come from the 20th Livestock Census (2019). Name that census in your head every time.
- Rajasthan had about 568 lakh livestock - second in India after Uttar Pradesh.
- That is roughly 10.6 per cent of the national herd.
- Livestock density is about 166 animals per sq km.
- Species share: goat 36.7% > cattle 24.5% > buffalo 24.1% > sheep 13.9%.
- Rajasthan is India's largest wool producer - about 48% of national output (47.85%, Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2025); Jammu and Kashmir is a distant second.
- In milk Rajasthan is second after Uttar Pradesh (about 14.8% of national output, BAHS 2025), and first in goat milk.

Rajasthan's all-India ranks - 20th Livestock Census (2019)

Rank in India	Rajasthan is	Remember it as
1st	Goat, camel, donkey	The desert trio
2nd	Total livestock, buffalo	Always behind Uttar Pradesh
4th	Sheep	Not first - wool is first, sheep is fourth
6th	Cattle	Surprisingly low
17th	Poultry	The weakest sector of the state

Species share, largest to smallest (20th Census)



TRAP

This is where marks are lost. Rajasthan is **FIRST** in goat, camel, donkey and wool - but only **SECOND** in total livestock, buffalo and milk, **FOURTH** in sheep, **SIXTH** in cattle and **SEVENTEENTH** in poultry. Note the split personality: first in wool but fourth in sheep. The Rajasthani sheep gives a lot of wool per head, that is all. Also, cattle and buffalo shares are almost identical (24.5 and 24.1) - if an ordering question comes, cattle sits above buffalo.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the 21st Livestock Census was enumerated between October 2024 and February 2025, covering 16 species and 219 registered indigenous breeds. Its full state tables are not yet the standard reference, so answer every census question from the 20th Census (2019) unless the question itself names the 21st.

Cattle breeds - the biggest matching set in the chapter

Eight cattle breeds are examinable. Sort them in your head by purpose, not alphabetically. Milch breeds give milk, draught breeds pull the plough, dual-purpose breeds do both. Rajasthan's star milch breed is the *Rathi*; its star draught breed is the *Nagauri*. Everything else hangs between those two poles.

Cattle breed to home tract to speciality

Breed	Home tract in Rajasthan	Speciality / other name
Rathi	Bikaner, Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Jaisalmer	Best milch breed - 'Kamdheni of Rajasthan'; named after the Rath community
Tharparkar	Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Barmer	Dual purpose; also Thari, Malani, White Sindhi

Breed	Home tract in Rajasthan	Speciality / other name
Nagauri	Nagaur	Premier draught breed; poor milker
Kankrej	Barmer, Jalore, Sirohi	Dual purpose; called Wadad / Waged / Wadhia; famous 'sawai chaal' gait
Gir	Ajmer, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh (origin Gir forests, Saurashtra)	Also Renderi or Ajmeri
Mewati	Alwar, Bharatpur	Also called Kosi, of the Mewat tract
Malvi	Jhalawar, Kota, Baran	The Hadoti / Malwa plateau breed
Haryana	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Alwar	Haryana-origin breed of the north-east

Rathi vs Tharparkar - the two the exam sets against each other

Rathi	Tharparkar
Best MILCH breed of Rajasthan	DUAL purpose - milk and draught
Bikaner, Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Jaisalmer	Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Barmer
Called the 'Kamdhenu of Rajasthan'	Called Thari, Malani or White Sindhi
Named after the Rath community	Named after the Thar / Tharparkar tract

- Purpose grouping: milch = Rathi; draught = Nagauri, Malvi; dual = Tharparkar, Kankrej, Haryana, Mewati.
- Gir and Kankrej are Gujarat-origin breeds that Rajasthan has adopted - both are asked as 'origin outside the state'.
- Kankrej's walking style, the 'sawai chaal', is a one-word giveaway in an option.
- Mewati = Kosi. If you see 'Kosi' in a list, it is the Alwar-Bharatpur cattle breed.

YAAD RAKHO

Trick for the four heavyweight cattle breeds and their districts: RA-TH-NA-KA. RAthi = Bikaner belt. THarparkar = Thar, so Jodhpur-Jaisalmer-Barmer. NAgauri = Nagaur, the name is the district. KAnkrej = Kankrej walks with 'sawai chaal' in Barmer-Jalore-Sirohi. Two of the four name their own home tract, which is half the work done.

TRAP

Do not put Gir in the north-west. Gir in Rajasthan means Ajmer, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh and the Hadoti side - never Hanumangarh or Bikaner. Second trap: Malvi (cattle, Hadoti) and Malpura (sheep, Tonk) are different animals with similar-looking names.

Buffalo - remember one negative fact

Buffalo is where a single sentence wins the question. Rajasthan has NO indigenous buffalo breed of its own. Every buffalo you see in a Rajasthani list came from somewhere else - Haryana, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh. Yet the state is second in India in buffalo population, because farmers here rear other people's breeds in large numbers.

Buffalo breeds reared in Rajasthan

Breed	Reared in Rajasthan mainly in	Speciality
Murrah	Alwar, Bharatpur, Shekhawati belt	Highest milk yield in India - 'black gold'; Haryana origin
Surti	Udaipur, Banswara	Gujarat origin, medium milker
Bhadawari	Eastern Rajasthan - Dholpur, Karauli side	Highest fat in milk, up to about 13%

Breed	Reared in Rajasthan mainly in	Speciality
Jafarabadi	Kept in small numbers	India's heaviest buffalo; origin Gir region, Saurashtra, Gujarat

- Rajasthan is 2nd in India in buffalo population despite owning no native buffalo breed.
- Buffaloes are about 24.1% of the state's livestock - just below cattle.
- Murrah = quantity of milk. Bhadawari = quality (fat) of milk. That single contrast is the whole buffalo question.

Sheep and wool - the section Rajasthan leads India in

Eight sheep breeds, and each one is famous for exactly one thing. Learn the superlative attached to the name and the district follows. Chokla for fineness, Nali for fleece weight, Jaisalmeri for body size, Marwari for sheer numbers, Magra for lustre. RPSC does not ask you about sheep husbandry; it asks 'which breed is called the Jewel of Rajasthan' and moves on.

Sheep breed to home tract to speciality

Breed	Home tract	Speciality
Chokla	Churu, Jhunjhunu, Sikar (Shekhawati)	Finest carpet wool in India; 'Jewel of Rajasthan', 'Indian Merino'
Magra (Bikaneri)	Bikaner, Nagaur, Jaisalmer, Churu	Only lustrous white carpet-wool breed of the region
Marwari	Jodhpur, Pali, Barmer, Jalore, Nagaur	Black face, small tubular ears; most numerous sheep of the state
Nali	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Churu, Jhunjhunu	Densest and heaviest fleece of the state's breeds
Pugal	Bikaner-Jaisalmer border	Black face with brown stripes above the eyes

Breed	Home tract	Speciality
Jaisalmeri	Jaisalmer, Barmer, Jodhpur	Largest-bodied sheep; Roman nose, long drooping ears
Malpura	Jaipur, Tonk, Sawai Madhopur	Home tract of CSWRI Avikanagar
Sonadi (Chanothar)	Udaipur, Dungarpur, Chittorgarh	Large drooping ears; also milked

Chokla vs Magra - the two the paper loves to swap

Chokla	Magra
Shekhawati: Churu, Jhunjhunu, Sikar	Bikaner core, spreading to Nagaur, Jaisalmer, Churu
FINEST carpet wool in India	Most LUSTROUS white wool of the region
'Jewel of Rajasthan', 'Indian Merino'	Also simply called 'Bikaneri'
Light, reddish-brown face, polled	White fleece prized by carpet weavers

YAAD RAKHO

The five sheep superlatives in one line - Chokla is finest, Nali is heaviest fleece, Jaisalmeri is biggest body, Marwari is most numerous, Magra is most lustrous. Say it as: FINE-HEAVY-BIG-MANY-SHINY = Chokla, Nali, Jaisalmeri, Marwari, Magra.

Wool - Rajasthan's number one

- Rajasthan produces about 48% of India's wool (47.85%, Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2025) - rank 1, with Jammu and Kashmir second.
- Bikaner has Asia's largest wool market.
- Bikaner and Jodhpur are the state's main wool-scouring and pressing centres.
- The Central Wool Development Board, under the Union Ministry of Textiles, has its headquarters at Jodhpur.
- Rajasthan's wool is mostly coarse carpet wool, not apparel wool - that is why the state feeds the carpet industry, not the suiting industry.

- Avika Kavach is the sheep insurance scheme; the Central Sheep and Wool Research Institute at Avikanagar is the research arm.

Goats – the state's largest single species

More than a third of Rajasthan's animals are goats, and Rajasthan has the largest goat population of any Indian state. The goat is the poor household's animal – it needs no pasture, eats thorn scrub, and can be sold in a bad month. Two names carry the whole examinable weight: Sirohi for meat, Jakhrana for milk.

Goat breed to tract to speciality

Breed	Home tract	Speciality
Sirohi	Sirohi, Pali, Ajmer, adjoining Udaipur	Leading MEAT breed; brown with white patches; used to upgrade goats across India
Jakhrana	Jakhrana village near Behror, Alwar	Highest MILK-yielding goat of Rajasthan; black with white spots on ears and muzzle
Marwari	Jodhpur, Barmer, Jaisalmer, Pali	Black, long-haired desert goat
Barbari	Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur	Small, stall-fed goat of the eastern districts
Jamunapari	Chambal ravines of Dholpur-Karauli	Tallest Indian goat breed

- Goats are about 36.7% of Rajasthan's livestock – the single largest species group.
- Rajasthan is 1st in India in goat population and 1st in goat milk.
- Lohi is a red-brown breed of the Pali-Sirohi-Jalore tract; state lists count it among Rajasthan's goats, so if an option pairs Lohi with that tract, take it.

- Sirohi = mutton, Jakhrana = milk, Jamunapari = height, Barbari = small and stall-fed. Four words, four breeds.

TRAP

Jakhrana is a GOAT, not a sheep. RPSC has used it as the odd one out in a list of sheep breeds. Equally, Magra is a SHEEP but is also called 'Bikaneri', while 'Bikaneri' in a camel list is the heavy draught camel. Read which animal the question is about before you match the district.

The camel - state animal, and a species in decline

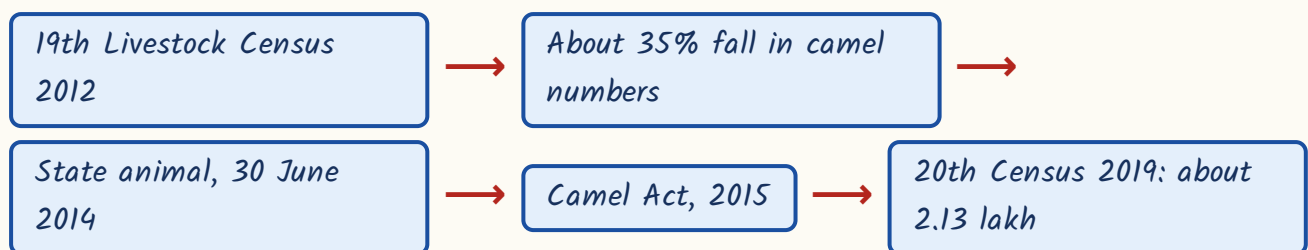
The camel is the one animal in this chapter with a story, and RPSC likes the story. Rajasthan holds roughly 85 per cent of India's camels, yet the population is collapsing - it fell by about 35 per cent between the 19th Census (2012) and the 20th (2019), down to about 2.13 lakh. Tractors replaced camel carts, grazing land shrank, and the animal lost its economic use. The state's response was legal protection: state animal status, then a slaughter-and-export law.

- Camel declared the state animal of Rajasthan on 30 June 2014 - replacing the older animal symbols in state usage.
- The Rajasthan Camel (Prohibition of Slaughter and Regulation of Temporary Migration or Export) Act, 2015 gives it legal protection.
- Rajasthan is 1st in India in camel population - about 2.13 lakh in the 20th Census, roughly 85% of the country's camels.
- The fall from the 19th (2012) to the 20th (2019) Census was about 35%.
- The National Research Centre on Camel, set up in 1984, is at Jorbeed in Bikaner.
- The Pushkar fair in Ajmer is the state's famous camel fair.

Camel breed to tract to use

Breed	Principal tract	Use / speciality
Bikaneri	Bikaner	Heavy draught - load carrying
Jaisalmeri	Jaisalmer	Fast riding breed
Nachna	Nachna area, Jaisalmer	Swift riding breed
Gomat	Jaisalmer-Jodhpur	Riding type of the Gomat tract
Mewari	Udaipur, Rajsamand	Hill camel; the best milker among camels
Kachchhi	Barmer, Jalore	Kutch-origin breed of the south-west

Why the camel got legal cover - the sequence to remember



Horses, poultry and the institutions that get asked

Horses are a small sector but a reliable one-mark question, because the Marwari horse has a physical marking nobody forgets - its ear tips curve inward and touch. Poultry, by contrast, is Rajasthan's weakest livestock sector: rank 17 in India. Do not expect a poultry question beyond that rank.

- Marwari horse - inward-curving ear tips that meet at the top; the signature Rajasthan horse.
- Malani horse - the Barmer strain, closely related to the Marwari.
- Kathiawari horse - reared in the Jalore-Barmer belt; Gujarat origin.
- The Equine Production Campus of the National Research Centre on Equines is at Bikaner.
- The Mallinath fair at Tilwara in Barmer is the state's famous horse fair.

- Poultry: Rajasthan ranks only 17th in India – the weak spot in an otherwise strong livestock profile.

The institutions – learn the city, that is all that is asked

Livestock and dairy institutions of Rajasthan

Institution	Location	Set up
RAJUVAS – Rajasthan University of Veterinary and Animal Sciences	Bikaner	2010
National Research Centre on Camel	Jorbeed, Bikaner	1984
Central Sheep and Wool Research Institute (CSWRI)	Avikanagar, Malpura tehsil, Tonk district	1962
Central Wool Development Board (Ministry of Textiles)	Jodhpur	-
Equine Production Campus, NRC on Equines	Bikaner	-
Rajasthan Co-operative Dairy Federation (RCDF)	Jaipur	1977

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016, 2018 and 2023 – the National Research Centre on Camel is at BIKANER. Three papers, the same fact. Bikaner also carries RAJUVAS and the Central Institute for Arid Horticulture, so 'Bikaner' is the safest answer in any Rajasthan animal-research question.

ASKED IN RAS

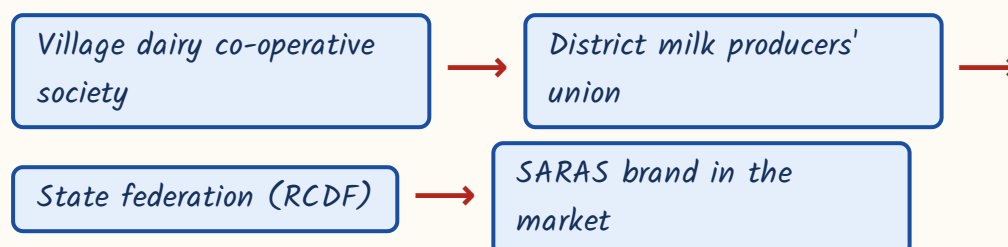
Asked as a match in RAS Pre 2018 and again in 2023 – research institute to location: NRC on Seed Spices = Ajmer, Central Institute for Arid Horticulture = Bikaner, CAZRI = Jodhpur (1959), NRC on Camel = Bikaner. Add CSWRI = Avikanagar (Tonk) and Central Wool Development Board = Jodhpur, and you have covered every version of this question.

Dairy - RCDF and the Saras brand

Rajasthan's dairy sector runs on the co-operative model copied from Amul. Milk is collected at the village, pooled at the district, processed and sold by the state federation. The federation is RCDF and the brand you see on the packet is SARAS. Learn the year, the headquarters and the brand - that trio is the question.

- Rajasthan Co-operative Dairy Federation (RCDF) was set up in 1977, headquarters Jaipur.
- It markets milk and milk products under the brand SARAS.
- It follows the three-tier Anand pattern: village dairy co-operative society, district milk producers' union, state federation.
- The parent model is NDDB Anand and Operation Flood, led by Verghese Kurien - the Amul pattern.
- Rajasthan is India's 2nd largest milk producer after Uttar Pradesh (about 14.8% of national output, BAHS 2025) and 1st in goat milk.

The three-tier Anand pattern that RCDF follows



- Do not confuse the tiers with a government department - all three tiers are co-operatives, not offices.
- Amul is Gujarat's federation (GCMMF); RCDF is Rajasthan's equivalent, not a branch of Amul.

Fisheries, schemes and the livestock fairs

Rajasthan has no coastline, so there is no marine fishery here - only inland fishery in reservoirs and tanks. That single sentence answers most fisheries questions. The productive waters are the Chambal-basin reservoirs, Mahi Bajaj Sagar and Jaisamand, which is why fisheries and irrigation are studied together.

- Rajasthan is landlocked - inland fisheries only, based on reservoirs, tanks and ponds.
- Main fishery waters: Rana Pratap Sagar, Jawahar Sagar and Kota Barrage on the Chambal, plus Mahi Bajaj Sagar and Jaisamand.
- Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY), launched 2020, is the central umbrella scheme for fisheries.

Schemes you should be able to name

- Bhamashah Pashu Bima Yojana - state livestock insurance.
- Avika Kavach - insurance cover for sheep.
- Mukhyamantri Mangla Pashu Bima Yojana - announced in the 2024-25 state budget, free livestock insurance.
- Gopal Credit Card - 2024-25, credit for livestock rearers on the Kisan Credit Card pattern.
- Rashtriya Gokul Mission (central, 2014) - conservation and development of indigenous cattle breeds.
- National Livestock Mission - central scheme for breed improvement, feed and fodder.

Livestock fairs - fair to place to animal

Fair	Place (district)	Known for
Pushkar fair	Pushkar, Ajmer	Camels

Fair	Place (district)	Known for
Mallinath fair	Tilwara, Barmer	Horses
Ramdeoiji cattle fair	Nagaur	Cattle
Baldev pashu mela	Merta, Nagaur	Cattle
Gogamedi fair	Gogamedi, Hanumangarh	Cattle and the Gogaji shrine
Tejaji cattle fair	Parbatsar, Nagaur	Cattle; held in Bhadrapad
Chandrabhaga fair	Jhalrapatan, Jhalawar	Cattle; on Kartik Purnima

ASKED IN RAS

Cattle fairs are asked from the culture side too. RAS Pre 2013 asked where the Tejaji cattle fair is held - PARBATSAR in Nagaur (Tejaji was born at Kharnal in the same district). RAS Pre 2016 asked where the Chandrabhaga cattle fair is held - JHALRAPATAN in Jhalawar. Two districts, Nagaur and Jhalawar, cover both.

REVISION RECAP

- 20th Livestock Census 2019: about 568 lakh animals, 2nd in India, 10.6% of the national herd, density about 166 per sq km.
- Species order: goat 36.7 > cattle 24.5 > buffalo 24.1 > sheep 13.9 per cent.
- Rank 1 in goat, camel, donkey and wool; 2nd in total livestock, buffalo and milk; 4th sheep, 6th cattle, 17th poultry.
- Wool about 48% of India's output (47.85%, BAHS 2025); Bikaner has Asia's largest wool market; Central Wool Development Board at Jodhpur.
- Rathi = best milch cattle, Kamdhenu of Rajasthan, Bikaner-Ganganagar belt.
- Tharparkar = dual purpose, Thari or Malani or White Sindhi, Jodhpur-Jaisalmer-Barmer.
- Nagauri = draught. Kankrej = Wadad/Wadhiar, sawai chaal, Barmer-Jalore-Sirohi.
- Mewati = Kosi (Alwar-Bharatpur); Malvi = Hadoti; Gir = Ajmer-Bhilwara-Chittorgarh; Hariana = Sikar-Jhunjhunu-Alwar.
- No indigenous buffalo breed in Rajasthan. Murrah = most milk ('black gold'), Bhadawari = most fat, Jafarabadi = heaviest.
- Chokla = finest carpet wool, Jewel of Rajasthan, Indian Merino, Shekhawati tract.
- Nali = heaviest fleece; Jaisalmeri = largest body; Marwari = most numerous, black face; Magra = lustrous, Bikaner.

12. Pugal = brown stripes above the eyes; Malpura = Tonk-Jaipur; Sonadi = Chanothar, southern districts, also milked.
13. Sirohi = leading meat goat; Jakhrana (Alwar) = highest milk goat; Jamunapari = tallest; Barbari = small, stall-fed.
14. Camel: state animal 30 June 2014, Camel Act 2015, about 2.13 lakh, roughly 85% of India's camels, fell about 35% since 2012.
15. Camel breeds: Bikaneri draught, Jaisalmeri and Nachna riding, Gomat, Mewari best milker, Kachchhi in Barmer-Jalore.
16. Marwari horse = inward-curving ear tips; Mallinath fair at Tilwara, Barmer is the horse fair.
17. Institutions: RAJUVAS Bikaner 2010, NRC Camel Jorbeed Bikaner 1984, CSWRI Avikanagar (Tonk) 1962, CWDB Jodhpur, RCDF Jaipur 1977.
18. RCDF 1977, Jaipur, brand SARAS, three-tier Anand pattern from NDDB and Operation Flood.
19. Fisheries are inland only - Chambal reservoirs, Mahi Bajaj Sagar, Jaisamand; PMMSY since 2020.
20. Schemes: Bhamashah Pashu Bima, Avika Kavach, Mangla Pashu Bima (2024-25), Gopal Credit Card, Rashtriya Gokul Mission, National Livestock Mission.